

SYED ISMAIL

Bengaluru, India | Relocating to Germany

Target locations: Munich, Berlin, Hamburg

Retail Area Manager (Gebietsleiter) | 15 Years Multistore Operations

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Summary

Regional retail operations professional with 15+ years of experience managing multi-store portfolios in footwear, fashion accessories, and consumer electronics. Responsible for KPI tracking (LTL, conversion, UPT, ASP, ABV), audits, inventory accuracy, loss prevention, and SOP compliance in COCO formats. Experience in coaching Store Managers, stabilizing operations, and supporting store launches and relocations. Current role delivered €4.74M annual turnover with +5% LTL growth (2025). Targeting Munich, Berlin, Hamburg retail markets.

Core Skills

- **Retail Operations:** Multi-store operations, SOP execution, audits, compliance, loss prevention
- **Commercial KPIs:** LTL (Like-to-Like) growth, conversion, UPT (Units Per Transaction), ASP (Average Selling Price), ATV/AOV (Average Transaction/Order Value), category performance
- **People Leadership:** Store Managers, hiring, training, succession planning
- **Store Expansion:** New store launches, property scouting, lease negotiations, relocations
- **Customer Experience:** NPS, service standards, issue resolution, retention
- **Analytics & Tools:** Power BI, Excel, MIS reporting, performance dashboards

Experience

Bata India Limited

June 2022 – Present

Area Sales Manager

Bengaluru, India

- Own Company owned and operated (COCO) store portfolio performance across Bengaluru and rest of Karnataka to drive sales, compliance, and execution.
- Run KPI cadence using Power BI and Excel; coach 18 Store Managers through audits and action plans.
- Delivered 4.74 million Euros annual turnover with +5% LTL growth in 2025 through category and conversion focus.
- Led business expansion by scouting properties, negotiating leases, executing relocations, and hiring teams.

Accessorize London (Payroll: Planet Retail Holdings Pvt. Ltd.)

October 2016 – June 2022

Area Manager / Retail Operations Officer

Bengaluru, India

- Led end-to-end retail operations for a 12-store network across South and East India markets.
- Executed SOP audits, VM standards, inventory controls, and replenishment routines across stores.
- Improved availability and reduced pilferage risk through tighter stock governance and compliance checks.
- Scaled new store launches including hiring, training, VM execution, and go-live stabilization.

Accessorize London (Payroll: Planet Retail Holdings Pvt. Ltd.)

October 2016 – January 2020

Store Manager

Bengaluru, India

- Drove monthly, quarterly, and annual sales targets with sustained positive LTL growth.
- Managed hiring, training, scheduling, and performance coaching for store teams of 10+ staff.
- Maintained inventory accuracy and SOP compliance to support audit readiness and shrink control.
- Led new store opening activities including recruitment, VM execution, and launch operations.

Logitech India Pvt. Ltd.**April 2013 – September 2016***Store Manager**Bengaluru, India*

- Owned daily store operations to achieve sales targets through staffing and floor discipline.
- Improved customer experience by resolving escalations and reinforcing service standards.
- Optimized merchandising layouts to improve product visibility and sell-through rates.

Ample Technologies Pvt. Ltd.**May 2012 – April 2013***Executive – Retail Sales**Bengaluru, India*

- Supported Apple reseller store sales through customer engagement and solution selling.
- Implemented inventory handling controls to reduce stock loss and improve availability.
- Ensured process compliance and strengthened customer relationships through follow-through.

Nokia**April 2010 – July 2011***Solutions Specialist**Bengaluru, India*

- Enabled customer adoption of mobile solutions through structured demonstrations and support.
- Resolved product inquiries efficiently to improve satisfaction and outlet performance.
- Maintained product expertise to support consistent service and sales outcomes.

Education

Rabindranath Tagore University (RNTU)**2017 – 2019***Bachelor of Commerce (B.Com)**India***Certifications & Awards**

- Best Store Manager — Accessorize London (2018)
- Best Visual Merchandiser — Accessorize London (2019)
- Best Area Manager — Accessorize London (2021)
- Certificate of Excellence — Count on Me, Bata India Limited (2024)

Languages

- English — Full Professional Proficiency (C2)
- German — Intermediate Working Proficiency (B1)